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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Legal Assistant role at Southwark Council's Childcare legal team stands out to me because it requires exactly the kind of hands-on case management and court support work I have been building toward: drafting applications, managing electronic bundles, maintaining accurate case files and meeting court deadlines. My background at BCLP and Citizens Advice gives me direct experience of each of those responsibilities.

At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with court filings, maintained matter records in iManage and tracked competing deadlines across several concurrent matters. At one point in the International Arbitration team I became the only junior supporting the group shortly before a major submission deadline, which required me to coordinate documents, monitor outstanding actions and help ensure everything was filed on time. That kind of pressure is a reasonable test of whether deadline management is genuinely reliable rather than just claimed, and the feedback I received from the supervising partner and associate afterwards confirmed it was.

At Citizens Advice I work directly with clients on matters involving welfare benefits, housing, debt and family issues. I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence and maintain confidential case records throughout each matter. Many of the clients I advise are in genuinely difficult circumstances, so communicating clearly, accurately and sensitively is not optional. That experience of combining procedural rigour with client-facing responsibility is, I think, relevant to a childcare team where the legal work directly affects vulnerable individuals and families.

Southwark's childcare legal function deals with proceedings that carry real consequences for children and parents. I want to work in a setting where careful, accurate legal support matters and where the work connects to broader questions of public protection and welfare, and this role fits that clearly. The hybrid structure, with regular onsite working at a busy council legal team, also suits how I work best.

I am available immediately and would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva